



TIPS & TRICKS



Viewing the contents of *tar* and *rpm* files

Here are two simple commands to show you the contents of the *tar* and *rpm* files.

1. To view the contents of a *tar* file, issue the following command:

```
#tar -tvf /path/to/file.tar
```

2. To view the contents of an *rpm* file, use the command given below:

```
#rpm -qip /path/to/file.rpm
```



Identifying your current shell name

You can identify your current shell name by using the following commands:

```
[Munish@CentOS]# echo $SHELL  
/bin/bash
```

The 'SHELL' environment variable stores the name of the current shell.

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How to make your shell prompt colourful

You might have got bored of the 'white on black' type of the shell prompt. Thankfully, you can customise the colours of the shell prompts according to your preferences. A one-liner dumped in the '~/.bashrc' or '~/.bash_profile' will make your terminal look more graceful. You just need to have some basic knowledge of the colour codes used in bash, which are listed here:

Black : \e[1;30m
Red : \e[1;31m
Green : \e[1;32m
Yellow : \e[1;33m
Blue : \e[1;34m
Purple : \e[1;35m
Cyan : \e[1;36m
White : \e[1;37m



Note: The above colours will display the text in bold. To display normal text, replace '1' with '0'.

Ex. Cyan : \e[0;36m

Besides, here are some prompt variables:

\u : Username of the present user
\w or \W : Current working directory
\h or \H : Host name
\t or \T : Current time
\\$: Prompt character

So, in order to provide a green shell prompt to the users, you would edit the ~/.bashrc or ~/.bash_profile file as follows:

```
PS1='\e[1;32m)[\u@\h \w]\$'\e[0m]
```

You can also try a multi-coloured shell prompt with the following line:

```
PS1='\e[0;31m)\u\[\e[m] \[\e[1;34m)\w\[\e[m] \[\e[0;31m)\$ \[\e[m]\[\e[0;32m)\'
```

Just give it a try.

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